Bullpen: Project Brief

Working name. A 50/50 venture between the two founders. Prepared October 2026 to bring Alex (and Alex's Claude) up to speed on the concept, the tools and the buildout.

1. The idea in one paragraph

A Duolingo-style app for learning to invest, built around competition. Players take short lessons (3-5 minutes, quiz questions, XP, streaks, badges) and climb weekly leagues and knowledge rankings. Alongside the lessons is a fake-money trading game (stocks, ETFs, crypto, gold) scored per season on risk-adjusted returns, so luck matters less. Players rank globally, by country, and by school ("#3 at AUB"). We launch with campus competitions at AUB and IC in Beirut, then expand to other Lebanese universities and the Gulf.

2. Decisions already made

- **Fake money only.** No entry fees or cash prizes: paid contests with prizes can count as gambling in many places. Prizes come from sponsors.
- **Skill over luck.** Rankings combine a knowledge score (lessons and quizzes) with a trading score based on risk-adjusted return over a full season, plus a long-term rating built across seasons.
- **Anti-cheating:** one account per phone number, one account per season, no mid-season resets. Orders fill at the next price received after the order, never at a stale price on screen.
- **Pebble stays separate.** Pebble (the broker-connected analytics site) is not part of this partnership. Any shared code or cross-promotion gets agreed in writing.
- **Under-18 users** (e.g. IC students) get the learning side only: no social links, no ads, no broker referrals.
- **Lessons teach concepts, never personal advice** (no "buy X now") and never promise earnings.

3. Tools and stack

Area	Tool	Why
App (iPhone, Android, web)	Expo (React Native), TypeScript	One codebase for all three platforms. Builds iPhone apps in the cloud, so no Mac is needed. React skills carry over.
Animations and charts	Reanimated, Skia, Rive or Lottie	The smooth, game-like feel (Duolingo-style).
Backend	Supabase	Accounts, Postgres database, live leaderboards, server functions.
Marketing site and waitlist	Next.js on Vercel	Fast, shows up in Google, separate from the app.
Subscriptions	RevenueCat	Handles App Store and Google Play billing in one place.
Price data	A market data provider (to be chosen)	Delayed or end-of-day stock prices plus crypto. Must allow showing prices to the public. Likely the biggest fixed cost.
AI features	Claude API	Drafting lessons (reviewed by a human expert) and the AI trade coach.
Building	Claude Code	Both founders build with Claude Code.
Payments and company	US LLC (e.g. Stripe Atlas or Doola), US business bank	Stripe isn't available in Lebanon; also makes 50/50 ownership clean.
App stores	Apple Developer ($99/yr), Google Play ($25 once)	Register under the company. Apple needs a free D-U-N-S number (apply early).

4. How we work

- **Roles:** the AUB/IC alum leads outreach to students, clubs, professors and teachers. Alex leads either building or content and short videos, depending on strengths. Both review product decisions.
- **Weekly rhythm:** one planning call, a shared task board, and a short written update each week (shipped, learned, next).
- **Code:** one GitHub repository both founders own. Work happens on branches and gets reviewed before merging.
- **Money:** one business bank account. Every contribution from each founder is recorded.
- **Paperwork first:** LLC with an operating agreement covering vesting (e.g. 4 years, 1-year cliff), how ties are broken, expected hours and roles, and that Pebble stays outside the company.

5. Buildout

Phase	When	What gets done
0. Set up	Weeks 1-2	LLC and operating agreement, bank account, GitHub, Supabase and Vercel projects, apply for D-U-N-S, Apple and Google accounts.
1. Test demand	Weeks 1-3	Interview 15-20 AUB students and a few at IC. Reach finance clubs and business school (OSB) professors. Recruit a finance professor to review lessons. Landing page with waitlist. Start posting short videos.
2. First version	Weeks 4-12	Lessons with quizzes, XP, streaks, badges. Weekly leagues of ~30 with promotion and demotion. School, country and global leaderboards. Trading game (stocks, ETFs, crypto, gold) scored per season. Profiles and shareable result images. About 40-60 polished lessons.
3. Pilot on web	Late in phase 2	Students open a link (e.g. from WhatsApp), no install. Fix things daily. Pilot users double as the 12 testers Google requires for new personal developer accounts.
4. Season 1	Feb 2027 (spring semester)	"AUB Investing Cup, Season 1" co-hosted with a club or professor, small sponsored prize. Publish to the App Store and Google Play.
5. Grow and charge	After Season 1	Pro subscription, options trading as a Pro feature, AI trade coach, teacher dashboard, sponsored seasons, then other universities and the Gulf.

6. How we make money

- **Pro subscription (main income):** unlimited lives, no ads, advanced courses (options, valuation), AI trade coach, detailed stats, verified social badge, extra leagues. Roughly $10-15/month or $80-100/year.
- **Small purchases:** streak freezes, extra lives, profile cosmetics.
- **Rewarded ads** for free adult users ("watch an ad to refill lives"). Block scam crypto ad categories.
- **Certificates** students can put on a CV, ideally backed by a university.
- **School and club licenses:** teacher or club dashboard, paid per semester.
- **Sponsors:** banks and fintechs sponsoring seasons, campus cups or course units. Likely the first real income.
- **Broker referrals** for adults ready to invest real money, always disclosed.

Planning assumption: 1-3% of monthly users pay (Duolingo, the best in class, gets about 8-9%).

7. Costs and the success test

Rough first-six-month budget: **$500-1,500**, mostly the LLC and price data. Supabase and Expo free tiers cover the pilot.

The one number that decides whether to invest more: the share of Season 1 players still active after four weeks. Around a quarter or more means keep going. If almost everyone quits in week one, fix the lessons before expanding.

8. Open questions for Alex

- Which role fits you best: building the app, or content and videos?
- How much capital can you put in over the first six months?
- Hours per week you can commit?
- Thoughts on the name (Bullpen, Pip, Candle, Rally or other)?

Note for Alex's Claude: treat the decisions in section 2 as settled unless Alex wants to revisit them. The first build target is a clickable prototype of the lesson, quiz and leaderboard flow to show AUB students.